

GitHub launches sponsorship programme to help open source contributors get paid for their work

GitHub recently launched a sponsorship programme to help open source software developers receive funding from the community that depends on their work, through their GitHub profiles.

Any GitHub user can sponsor an open source developer in the programme, called GitHub Sponsors.

The Microsoft-owned software development platform announced in a blog post, “We’re thrilled to announce the beta of GitHub Sponsors, a new way to financially support the developers who build the open source software you use every day. Open source developers build tools for the rest of us. GitHub Sponsors is a new tool to help them succeed, too.”

No platform fees will be charged to GitHub members when they support the work of other developers. Also, the company won’t charge payment processing fees for the first 12 months of the programme to celebrate the launch. That means 100 per cent of the sponsorship goes to the developer.

The company wrote in its blog, “GitHub Sponsors is built to fund all types of work that advance open source software. Anyone who contributes to open source, whether it is in the form of code, documentation, leadership, mentorship, design, and beyond, is eligible for sponsorship.”

The programme is in the beta stage right now and you have to join the waitlist in order to get approved as an eligible developer or contributor to receive sponsorships.

To jumpstart this new programme and boost community funding, the company is also launching the GitHub Sponsors Matching Fund. GitHub will match all contributions up to US\$ 5,000 during a developer’s first year in GitHub Sponsors.

“Wiwynn’s contribution to OCP OpenEDGE is an important step forward in the creation of a healthy ecosystem that provides far edge data centre equipment consumers with multi-source procurement options to avoid vendor lock-in,” Nikurautio added.

The OpenEDGE specification is part of the OCP’s mission to help bring open source hardware to the data centre market.

Red Hat completes open sourcing of 3scale code; invites developers to join its GitHub community

Red Hat has announced that the entire family of 3scale application programming interface (API) management products has been open sourced.



Red Hat acquired 3scale in 2016 to extend its management capabilities to address the increasing number of public APIs and the expanding use of internal APIs in containers and microservices. The company had then announced that it would launch an on-premise version of 3scale’s software and open source the code.

However, the process of open sourcing 3scale code wasn’t that easy. The company wrote in a blog post: “Taking an existing proprietary software package and opening the source involves more than just publishing the code to an open repository website. Inspection of the code is required to make sure that dependencies are under suitable open source licences.”

“In some cases, we may need to rewrite parts of the code base to make it suitable for release. Teams must also learn how to open source software and be prepared to start receiving input from developers outside the company. In short, it’s much more than throwing code over the wall. An open source project is a process, not an end result,” the blog post concluded.

The blog went on to add that the Red Hat team “...embarked on this process shortly after the acquisition, starting with the modules, such as our API gateway components that were of most interest to developers looking to extend functionality.”

After the acquisition by Red Hat, 3scale API management became part of the company’s larger integration suite that also includes Red Hat Fuse and Red Hat AMQ.

Three years back, Mike Piech, vice president and general manager of middleware at Red Hat, announced the acquisition in a blog post and said 3scale’s software complemented that of Red Hat’s.